JAVA BASICS · REFERENCE SHEET

How to Read a Java Method

1 The big idea

A method is a reusable block of code that does one specific job.

You give it information
The values it needs to work with

It performs a task
The steps inside the method run

It may give a result
An answer comes back to you

Like a recipe.
Ingredients go in, the steps happen, and a dish comes out. You can follow it again any time.

2 The parts of a method

Calculator.java

```
1 public static 2 int 3 calculateTotal(int price, int quantity) {
    4 return price * quantity;
}
```

← the method ends here

{ } Every method is a block of code. It begins with an opening curly brace { and ends with a closing curly brace }. Everything between them belongs to the method.

`static` You will see this word often. We'll explain it later.

1 Who can use it?

`public` means any code in the program is allowed to use this method.

2 What kind of result?

`int` is the return type. This method promises to give back a whole number.

3 What is its job? What does it need?

The name `calculateTotal` describes the job. The parentheses list the information it needs: two `int` values called `price` and `quantity`.

4 What does it do? What comes back?

The body between { } holds the steps. `return` sends the answer back to whoever used the method.

3 Watch it work with real values

USING THE METHOD `int total = calculateTotal(5, 3);`

INPUTS

5 → price

3 → quantity

IT DOES ITS JOB

return price * quantity;

5 × 3 = 15

OUTPUT

15 total = 15